



Centre For Innovation

Office of Dean Students

IIT Madras

Chennai - 600 036



horizon_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in

<http://cfi.iitm.ac.in>

Centre for Innovation (CFI)

Indian Institute of Technology Madras

Application for the Core team, Centre for Innovation (CFI), 2026-2027

Name:		Nickname:	
Roll No:	Room No:	Hostel:	
Phone:	CGPA:	Email:	

Instructions and Conditions

1. The applications have to be submitted in PDF format with the name "Horizon_Core_26-27_<your name>_<roll number>".
2. Submit your latest grade copy in PDF format alongwith your application in the google form.
3. Meet and discuss with all relevant members from the previous team.

Notes:

- a) Deadline for submission: **11th March 2026, 11:59 pm.**
- b) Don't include apparent points. Focus more on novelty and innovation.
- c) Be concise. Don't re-emphasise something you've already mentioned. Excessive wordiness and beating around the bush is not recommended.
- d) Bullet points are preferred over sprawling paragraphs.
- e) Text should be Calibri, Minimum Font Size – 11.

A Note from the Core Team:

Most of the questions in this application are subjective in nature. There is no fixed right or wrong answer to them. We want to know your approach to leadership and understand how you think. Therefore, use AI diligently, and ensure that it does not replace your original thinking.

Your very own Horizon journey at the highest level has begun.

Ensure you have fun along the way.

All the best!!



Centre For Innovation

Office of Dean Students

IIT Madras

Chennai - 600 036



horizon_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in

<http://cfi.iitm.ac.in>

About you:

1. Introduce yourself and mention your experience, learning, growth, and all the commitments from the last tenure (i.e., 25-26). Mention all commitments and PoRs apart from Horizon as well. How would your strengths, skills & weaknesses affect your responsibilities in the role? How will your previous experiences help you in your tenure as a head/strategist of Horizon?
2. How would you deal with the situation if you faced issues in your tenure regarding time management between CFI and your academics/career? Briefly describe your plan for work distribution among the club's heads and strategists.

CFI and Finance

3. Please provide a tentative budget for your tenure at the club. Briefly explain the process and logistics of acquiring the requested funds. What are the various ways in which we get funds from CFI/STACT?
4. What do you think is the role of Horizon in the co-curricular/tech sphere of IIT Madras?
5. How are inter-club relations in CFI and any other institute organisation? What would your approach be to resolve inter-club conflicts?

Initiatives

6. What is your vision for Horizon for the upcoming tenure? How has this year been, and what changes would you like to make to improve it?
7. What new initiatives would you like to take during your tenure? Majorly emphasizing improving club structure, and projects and contributing to the innovation and learning ecosystem at IIT Madras.
8. Review the initiatives that were started this tenure. Write down their pros and cons. Mention how many you want to continue and what changes you want to introduce to them.

Publicity

9. Despite the absence of strict vertical divisions within the club, Horizon's smooth functioning requires expertise in areas such as design, web development, PR, and social media management.
 - a. Provide an analysis of the current status of these domains within Horizon. What are our strengths, and where do we lack?
 - b. Evaluate Horizon's current social media presence and the impact of initiatives like Astrobytes.



- c. What new ideas or formats (e.g., reels, short-form content, etc.) would you introduce to make our presence more engaging and impactful?
 - d. How do you plan to train and equip coordinators to build expertise in these domains?
10. How significant has the website been in the publicity of Horizon? How are you planning to continue the development and maintenance of our website?
11. We initially (in the previous years) had a separate writing team to handle the annual magazine, articles, monthly newsletter, and biweekly astrobytes. Later, this was merged into the coordinators' work
- a. Why do you think this was done?
 - b. How do you think this affected the consistency of things going out in time?
 - c. How could this have been handled better and how would you ensure originality, and creativity in our work?
12. Media work like posters, mails, WhatsApp messages, linkedin posts, etc often gets delayed. Why? How do you think this can be optimised? Also, how would you train coordinators to handle all these responsibilities properly?

Outreach

13. By being a core member, you become the primary point of contact for anyone willing to reach out to Horizon: Professors, other Colleges/Universities, IITM Students, etc. How would you contact others externally and handle the incoming information/requests?
14. Horizon's projects and events have largely remained internal, with limited engagement with industry or external research institutes.
- a. Should Horizon approach companies and research institutes for sponsorships and collaborations for any of our events?
 - b. What are your plans to scale up the Horizon projects, and how do you intend to enhance industry outreach so that our projects can have a direct impact on the world?
 - c. What potential risks or constraints should be considered?
15. This year, Horizon conducted the Qiskit Fall Fest, a global quantum computing event.
- a. Briefly explain what happened at this event, and what its results were.
 - b. Perform a SWOT analysis for this event.



- c. Do you think we should continue hosting Qiskit Fall Fest next year as well? If yes, list the critical changes and new initiatives you plan to introduce. If not, explain why you would not want to conduct the event.
16. CAMS has the potential to function either as a standalone project or as a mini-project under Coordinators, DCs, and/or the AP team. Evaluate both approaches and suggest which structure would be more effective for Horizon.
17. In the past, Horizon has received collaboration proposals that, upon further evaluation, did not align with our goals or turned out to lack credibility, leading to time being spent on unproductive discussions. How would you evaluate and filter collaboration requests to ensure we invest time only in meaningful and credible partnerships?

Astronomy / AP Team

18. Horizon Trip
 - a. Over the past four years, which locations were selected for Horizon's annual trip?
 - b. Analyse the reasons these locations were chosen. What advantages did they offer, and what logistical challenges were encountered?
 - c. Propose a destination for the upcoming annual trip (you may suggest a new location if suitable). Develop a preliminary plan taking into account the academic calendar, weather, and other factors. Justify your choice and planning strategy.
19. Describe the current inventory of Horizon as far as astronomy equipment goes. What do you think are some improvements that can be made to our inventory?
20. Has Horizon appropriately been portrayed as the Physics "**AND**" Astronomy Club. Do you think there is a balance between the Physics and Astronomy projects and events? If you perceive an imbalance, propose ways to address it.
21. **Astrophotography team:** Review the work progress of the AP team. How many new objects have they captured? Highlight major challenges faced (technical, logistical or coordination-related). Interact with the team members and incorporate their inputs into your review.

Events

22. Even though our club has several events, **Night-Sky Observation Sessions** still remain our most popular, biggest, and of course our flagship event.



- a. Understand and describe in detail the complete logistics required to organise Observation Sessions
 - b. Do you think specialized observation sessions should be conducted for different groups (e.g., Master's students, PhD scholars, campus residents)? Explain your reasoning, including potential advantages and drawbacks.
 - c. If KV Grounds is unavailable, what alternative venues can be considered? Why not just conduct it on the HSB rooftop?
 - d. Suggest concrete improvements for future Observation Sessions. Reflect on previously implemented systems (such as the token system). Can something be done to reduce the effort of transporting all the equipment?
23. Analyse Horizon's other main events (Guide to Galaxy, Quarks to Quasars, Boltzmann, Freshie Roadmaps, zero shadow day) Identify their strengths and weaknesses. Do you plan to improve or change them in any way?
24. Do you think we had a lot of events this year? Did having a lot of events lead to less crowd in some of the events? If yes, how do you plan to tackle this?
25. In organising events, do you prefer fixed roles (the same coordinator handles the same responsibility across events), or dynamic roles (responsibilities assigned before each event through discussion and polling)?
26. How do you think you'd overcome the inertia of starting an event (like say, Treasure hunt) which might attract an audience but has the problem of not being a conventional Physics and/or Astronomy event, like say, a lecture/competition? Analyse these new planned or attempted events (Love dynamics, Treasure Hunt and Solar Observation session).
27. Are there any new events that you would want to conduct next year? Provide proper feasibility checks for the events you suggest.
28. Was maintaining an event calendar useful during this tenure?
29. What clubs can Horizon collaborate with for our events (Don't limit yourself to CFI clubs. Include TechSoc, E-Cell, Shaastra, and any other organisations in Insti.), and how will our club benefit from this? What challenges might you face? Analyse any past collaborative events.



Structure and Selections

30. What is the role of the Faculty Advisor in a club? To what extent should they be involved in decision making and activities, and how would you ensure to keep them in the loop with the club activities? Also, suggest a potential new Faculty Advisor for Horizon, if any.
31. What are the ways to monitor the progress of different members within clubs? Which of these would you want to implement, and how? Mention both the criteria and protocol for removal of members?
32. How do you gauge potential team members from the interested members of GSB? What can be the parameters that can be judged in an interview or an application that can be used to admit new members into the club? Answer specifically with regard to Coordinators, PMs, and DCs.
33. What do you think should be the structure and the work division within the core team? Do we need defined roles for everyone or should there be individuals with flexible/non-permanent roles in the core team?
34. Recall and describe your coordinator application and selection process. What would you like to change, and why? How many coordinators would you plan to take, and why?
35. Do you think it is important to involve Master's and PhD students in the club? If yes, how do you plan to increase their participation? Mention any initiatives you can think of towards this, and perform a first-order feasibility check on the same.
36. How would you ensure avoiding conflicts between coordinators or project members? In case a conflict has already ensued, how would you resolve it?

Management

37. Our club recruits first-year undergrads as Deputy Coordinators. Coordinators recruited and managed the DC Program.
 - a. Conduct a SWOT analysis of the current DC program.
 - b. Based on your assessment, what specific initiatives or responsibilities would you introduce to better engage, mentor, and develop the DCs throughout their tenure?
 - c. Identify the specific bottlenecks and challenges we faced during DC recruitment this year. What is your concrete plan to overhaul or tweak the recruitment process to tackle these issues in the future?
38. Reflecting on the team this year, how would you evaluate the current interaction levels (Coord-Coord, Coord-PM, and Coord&PM-Core)? Propose strategies to improve knowledge sharing,





foster better team bonding, and ensure that coordinators and PMs feel fully included and valued alongside senior members.

39. Long meeting durations have been a recurring bottleneck. Do you find the current meeting structure productive? If not, propose a clear framework or set of rules to optimise our meetings, ensuring they are concise, objective-driven, and respectful of everyone's time.
40. Slipping deadlines can severely impact the team's momentum. What psychological or structural mechanisms will you put in place to effectively enforce deadlines and ensure strict adherence and accountability from all members (PMs, Coords, and DCs)? If a team member (co-core, coord, pm) does not perform their role, how will you tackle the situation most professionally?
41. We wanted to sell T-shirts to the GSB but couldn't do so. What was the reason? Do you have any other suggestions for this? What is the procedure to order the T-shirts?

Projects

42. Current year projects:
- Conduct a SWOT of every project within the club. Did it reach the end goal defined for the project, if not why?
 - If it was an exploratory project, was the problem statement examined in depth?
 - How well were the projects documented?
 - What learnings can you take from this year's projects for the upcoming year?
43. Previous year projects:
- Review the types of projects undertaken in previous years and compare them with those taken up this year. In earlier years, we had a few collaborative projects with other clubs, whereas this year we have not had any.
- Based on your assessment, how do you think shared accountability between two or more clubs influences the project's planning and execution?
 - In what ways could working jointly with other clubs strengthen interclub relationships and broaden our outreach?
44. How many projects should we take on next year? What is your perspective on long-term projects? Do you want to continue any of the projects from this tenure, what criteria would you apply to choose them? How do you ensure novelty and avoid redundant projects?

45. Your project idea:



Centre For Innovation

Office of Dean Students

IIT Madras

Chennai - 600 036



horizon_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in

<http://cfi.iitm.ac.in>

(If you don't have a project idea, create a dummy project and answer the questions below accordingly.):

- a. Do you have a project that you want to lead next year? Describe your project idea
- b. Identify a Project Guide: PG/ Professor/ Research Park/ Any Expert in the Field (include name, designation, and relevance to the project).
- c. Create a rough timeline for the project (considering quizzes and vacation) and an approximate budget.
- d. What kind of work culture would you follow to ensure the proper completion of projects?
- e. Will there be some IP/Research Paper/Patent that can be issued after this project?

46. Project lead selection:

- a. What qualities do you look for in a project lead, and how do you ensure they are capable of successfully leading the project?
- b. If a project lead demonstrates deficiencies during their tenure, how do you address the situation? Additionally, what steps would you take if the project lead leaves the project midway through its completion?

47. Project manager:

(Talking to the Horizon's current project manager might help in answering the questions below)

- a. What do you think are the roles and responsibilities of a Project Manager?
- b. How would you go about selecting a potential Project Manager for the club?
- c. To what extent do you think they should be involved in the working of a project?
- d. How would you handle a situation where a Project Manager is not capable of effectively managing responsibilities across the PM team, the club, academics, and other commitments?

48. Functioning of a project:

- a. What is your take on having people from 24B or above as members in the project, how do you think this would affect the working and dynamics within the project?
- b. How will you deal with the situation of distributing work to project members, or if they are not contributing as much, not attending meetings, etc.?



- c. Projects often lose momentum during the semester and pick up only near major reviews. How would you ensure consistent progress throughout the year?
- d. If a project is underperforming, how would you intervene? Additionally, how would you evaluate the contribution of the project members?

49. Suppose you release the application for your project and do not receive enough applications. How would you handle this situation? What criteria would you use to decide whether to continue or discontinue the project?

50. Project Reviews:

- a. What is your opinion on project reviews? How useful do you think they are in ensuring consistent progress throughout the tenure of a project?
- b. How regularly should reviews be conducted, and what timeline would you propose?
- c. Who do you think should be the reviewers? Should there be a criteria for reviewing?
- d. Additionally, if a scheduled review has to be postponed due to quizzes, endsems, or the unavailability of the faculty advisor, how would you ensure that projects' momentum and accountability are maintained during that period?

Guild

51. Describe what you know about Horizon's Physics and Astronomy Guild, which is also a part of the Tech Contingent.

- a. Perform a SWOT analysis for the Guild.
- b. What were the achievements that the guild got this year?
- c. List the major competitions targeted by our Guild in the past 2 years.

52. Our Guild will be representing our institute and the country at the International Physicists' Tournament (IPT) 2026. Describe what you know about IPT, specifically focusing on our past participation, preparation, and performance.

Horizon Culture

53. Team bonding, right from PMs to the cores, is a big part of Horizon culture. Being in good rapport with all the members is crucial for maximising each person's efficiency in their contribution to the club.

- a. How do you plan to develop interpersonal relationships within the club?
- b. What challenges could you face, and how can you mitigate them?



Centre For Innovation

Office of Dean Students

IIT Madras

Chennai - 600 036



horizon_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in

<http://cfi.iitm.ac.in>

c. Describe possible difficulties in involving everyone in the club.

54. How would you maintain the relationship of club members with seniors and alums? Mention how you would utilise the club seniors' input for the betterment of Horizon.

Guild Captain

Note: The following section is optional but must be attempted if you are applying for the guild captain.

1. What were the initiatives/changes introduced in the guild this year? Building on that, list the new initiatives, events, or structural changes you plan to introduce during your tenure.
2. Provide a detailed timeline for the Guild, from the perspective of recruitments and competitions.
3. What specific metrics, deliverables, or frameworks will you implement to fairly and accurately gauge the individual contributions of Guild members throughout the year?
4. Propose a structured plan for Knowledge Transfer sessions. How will you ensure that the technical and strategic expertise of senior members is continuously and effectively passed down to incoming members?
5. Provide a detailed SWOT analysis specifically focusing on our past participation, preparation, and performance in the Indian National Physicists' Tournament (InPT) and the International Physicists' Tournament (IPT).
6. Detail your strategy for forming the InPT teams. When should the travelling contingent for IPT be finalised, and how will you establish a fair, objective, and effective priority order?
7. What is your roadmap for recruiting and training the Inter IIT contingent? To ensure continuous practice year-round, suggest similar, smaller-scale competitions we can participate that mirror the Inter IIT format.
8. Outline your proposed recruitment pattern for selecting new Guild members. If you plan to use multiple formats (e.g., written tests, interviews, task phases), provide a few sample questions or problem statements for each.
9. Prepare an expanded, non-exhaustive list of short-term competitions the Guild should actively target to maintain momentum and engagement outside of the major tournaments.
10. Funding international travel is a recurring challenge. What financial sources or corporate sponsorships can the Guild realistically target, and what is your action plan for approaching them?



Centre For Innovation

Office of Dean Students

IIT Madras

Chennai - 600 036



horizon_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in

<http://cfi.iitm.ac.in>

AP Team Lead

Note: The following section is optional but must be attempted if you are applying for the AP team lead.

1. The AP Team Lead is a core team role and entails both managerial duties within Horizon and responsibility for the club's equipment. Are you ok with this arrangement? Additionally, what will be your time commitment to this position, considering most of your work will be during the night?
2. After interacting with all AP team members, evaluate the overall level of participation during this tenure. Do you think all members were equally active? Analyse the reasons behind this? In this context, assess whether AP work receives the same importance and priority as other club projects, and determine the ideal team size for the next tenure based on workload.
3. The AP team began the tenure with multiple mini-projects, but not all were carried through to completion. Analyse the causes of this shortfall and outline mechanisms to ensure better execution and follow-through in the future. Additionally, explain how you would select and finalize mini-project ideas, and distribute work after that.
4. Presently every time AP team goes to the roof, we spend most of our time debugging NINA and the mount instead of capturing photos. Since such recurring technical issues can demotivate the team, how would you respond in this situation?
5. Investigate the issues faced by the AP team over the past two years (from 2023 to 2025) (e.g., documentation gaps, inventory management). Were these issues addressed effectively during the current tenure? What is your assessment of the team's current skill level in astrophotography?
6. What other issues from this tenure stood out to you, and how do you plan to address them?
7. Your next tenure
 - a. What is your vision for the AP team? Explain in detail all the new initiatives you plan to introduce. In this context what do you think should be done in the rainy seasons where we are not able to do AP.
 - b. The people that you recruit for the team may not have prior experience with telescopes or imaging equipment. How will you ensure they are trained efficiently and become capable of operating independently?
 - c. What do you prefer, weekly meetings on a fixed day or meeting only when the weather is good. Will the latter option lead to irregular work within the AP team? (Note: - This is one of the issues last year's AP team faced)
 - d. Do we really need new equipment apart from what we have currently? If yes, then how are we limited by our current equipment and what do you propose we get. If no, then justify your answer.



Centre For Innovation

Office of Dean Students

IIT Madras

Chennai - 600 036



horizon_cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in cfi@smail.iitm.ac.in

<http://cfi.iitm.ac.in>

- e. Suggest feasible astrophotography trip locations near Chennai. Research existing star parties or dark-sky gatherings that the team could participate in. Look for safe locations and find out the budget required for it. Find out how to finance these trips.



All The Best!